Writing a diary entry

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Know the parts and features of a diary entry (entrada de diario)
- Write in the first person and in the past simple
- Use connectors and time words to order events
- Express feelings and opinions, and check your text

Para pensar

¿Has escrito alguna vez un diario? ¿Qué cuenta alguien cuando escribe «Dear Diary, today was the best day ever...»?

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Rechazar Aceptar

Explicación

What is a diary?

A diary (or **journal**) is a notebook where people write about their days: what happened, what they thought and how they felt. Each text is called an entry. Diaries are **personal** and **informal**: you write for yourself, so you can be honest and use friendly language.

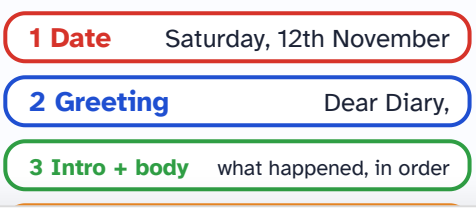
Some famous books are diaries, real or invented, and many explorers and scientists kept diaries of their trips. **En castellano:** *diary* es «diario» y, cuidado, también «agenda». *Journal* es más bien un cuaderno de notas o reflexiones.



The parts of an entry

A diary entry has a simple structure. **1. Date** at the top: «Saturday, 12th November». **2. Greeting** (optional): «Dear Diary,». **3. Introduction:** one or two sentences to say what the day was like: «Today was a strange day.»

4. Body: the events in order, with details. **5. Feelings:** how you felt and why. **6. Ending:** a final thought or something about tomorrow: «I can't wait for tomorrow!», «I hope I sleep well tonight.» You can sign with your name or **See you tomorrow!**



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First person and past simple

A diary is written in the first person: **I**, **me**, **my**, **we**, **us**, **our**. «**I** woke up late and **my** mum was angry.» «**We** went to the cinema.»

Most of the text is in the past simple, because we tell what happened today or yesterday: **I went**, **I saw**, **it was**, **we played**. Remember the regular *-ed* and the irregular verbs. At the end we can use the future: «Tomorrow I'**m going to** tell her.» **Consejo:** repasa la lista de irregulares antes de escribir.

Verb	Past
wake up	woke up
have breakfast	had breakfast
feel	felt
find	found

Ordering events: connectors

To tell the events in order, use time connectors: **First**, **Then**, **Next**, **After that**, **Later**, **In the afternoon**, **In the evening**, **Finally**, **At the end of the day**.

To join ideas, use **and** (y), **but** (pero), **because** (porque), **so** (así que) and **when** (cuando): «I was nervous **because** it was my first match.» «It started to rain, **so** we went home.» «I wanted to go out, **but** I had homework.» «**When** I arrived, everybody was singing.»

because I was nervous because...

so It rained, so we went home.

but I wanted to go, but...

when When I arrived, ...

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The heart of a diary is feelings. Use adjectives: **happy**, **excited** (emocionado), **proud** (orgulloso), **relieved** (aliviado), **surprised**, **nervous**, **worried** (preocupado), **scared**, **bored**, **disappointed** (decepcionado), **angry**, **sad**, **embarrassed** (avergonzado).

Say **why**: «I felt **proud** because I scored a goal.» «I was **disappointed** when the trip was cancelled.» Make them stronger with **very**, **really** or **so**: «I was **so** excited!» **Ojo:** *embarrassed* no es «embarazada», sino «avergonzado».



Adding details

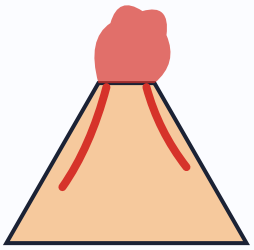
A good entry has details that make the reader see the scene. Instead of «I went to the park. It was good», write: «After school I went to the park with Leo. It was sunny and the leaves were orange and yellow. We played tag near the fountain and I fell in a puddle!»

Use the five senses: what did you **see**, **hear**, **smell**, **taste**, **touch**? Use adjectives and numbers: «a **huge** chocolate cake with **eleven** candles». Add what people **said**: «My teacher said, "Well done!"».



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Read Nil's entry: «**Wednesday, 9th March.** Dear Diary, today was an amazing day! In the morning we had a surprise in class: a real scientist came to talk about volcanoes. **First**, she showed us some rocks from Lanzarote. **Then** we made a small volcano with bicarbonate and vinegar. When it erupted, the red foam went everywhere, even on my trainers! Everybody laughed. **After that**, I asked her a question and she said it was a very good question. I felt really **proud**. **In the afternoon** I told my parents about it. **Finally**, I decided something: I'm going to be a volcanologist! See you tomorrow, Nil.»



When it erupted, everybody laughed!

Check your text

Before you finish, proofread (revisa) your entry with this checklist. ☐ **Date** at the top? ☐ **First person** (I, we)? ☐ **Past simple** verbs correct (went, not goed)? ☐ **Connectors** to put events in order? ☐ **Feelings** and reasons with *because*?

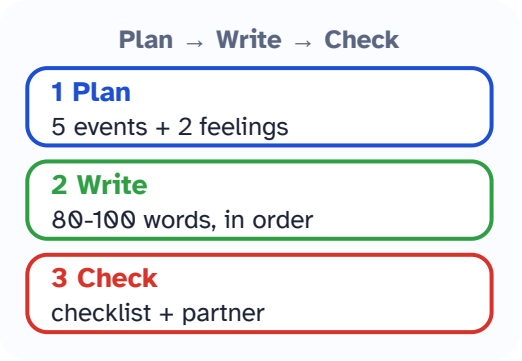
☐ **Capital letters** at the start of sentences, for **I**, names, days and months (Monday, March)? ☐ **Full stops** and commas? ☐ **Details** to make it interesting? Read it aloud: if something sounds strange, change it. A good writer always revises.

☐ **Date**	at the top
☐ **I / we**	first person
☐ **Past**	went, saw, was
☐ **Feelings**	because...
☐ **Capitals**	I, Monday, March

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Now it's your turn. Choose a **real day** (your birthday, a trip, a match, a day when something went wrong) or an **imaginary day** (a day as a pirate, a day on Mars). **Plan** first: write five key events in order and two feelings.

Then **write** 80-100 words using the structure: date, greeting, introduction, events with connectors, feelings, ending. Finally, **check** it with the checklist and swap with a partner: they can tell you one thing they liked and one thing to improve. **Consejo:** escribir un poco cada día en inglés es una forma estupenda de practicar.



A diary entry



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Ejercicios

1. **Write the date in English: viernes 6 de mayo.**

2. **Put in order: Finally / First / Then / After that.**

3. **Complete: «I was nervous ___ it was my first exam.»**

4. **Complete: «It was raining, ___ we stayed at home.»**

5. **Translate: orgulloso, aliviado, decepcionado.**

6. **Change to the past: «I wake up and I have breakfast.»**

7. **Add a feeling: «My grandma gave me a puppy.»**

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9. **Write a good ending for a diary entry.**

10. **Write a short entry (5 sentences) about today.**

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Practica

1. **A diary entry is written in the...**
   - **A)** third person
   - **B)** second person
   - **C)** first person
2. **Most of a diary entry is in the...**
   - **A)** past simple
   - **B)** future
   - **C)** present continuous
3. **What goes at the top?**
   - **A)** the title of a book
   - **B)** the date
   - **C)** your address
4. **«Dear Diary» is...**
   - **A)** an ending
   - **B)** a greeting
   - **C)** a connector
5. **Which word explains a reason?**
   - **A)** then
   - **B)** finally
   - **C)** because
6. **«Proud» means...**
   - **A)** orgulloso
   - **B)** preocupado
   - **C)** aburrido
7. **Which is correct?**
   - **A)** on monday i went to the pool.
   - **B)** On Monday I goed to the pool.
   - **C)** On Monday I went to the pool.

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B) for the last event

C) for a reason

9. **«Embarrassed» means...**

A) avergonzado

B) embarazada

C) enfadado

10. **Before finishing, you should...**

A) proofread your text

B) delete the date

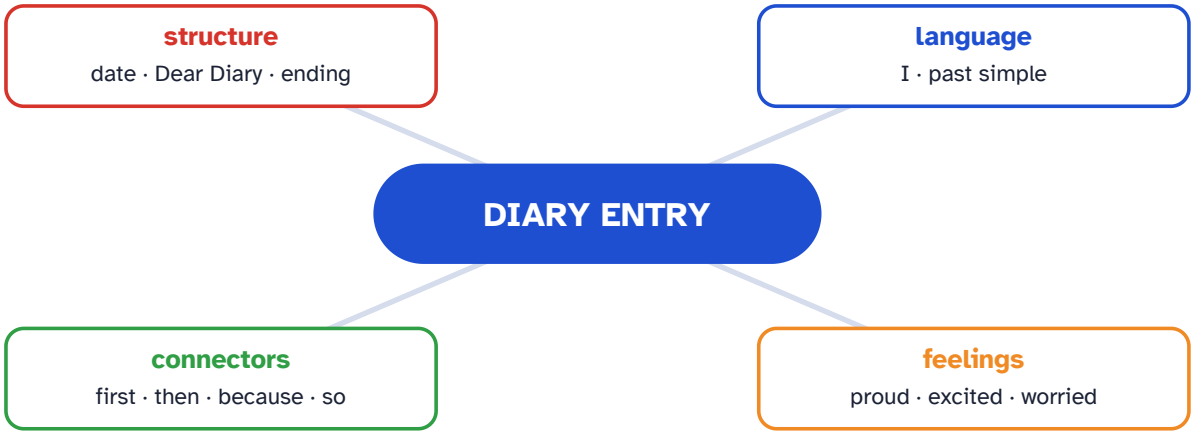
C) write in the present

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Qué es una entrada de diario y qué partes tiene; En qué persona y en qué tiempo verbal se escribe; Qué conectores ordenan los hechos y unen ideas; Cómo se expresan los sentimientos y cómo se revisa el texto.

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Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

diary / entry

Diario / cada texto del diario.

Dear Diary,

Saludo inicial.

first person

I, me, my, we.

First, Then, Finally

Ordenan los hechos.

because / so

Porque / así que.

proud

Orgulloso.

relieved

Aliviado.

proofread

Revisar el texto.

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Soluciones

1. **C)** I, we.
2. **A)** Contamos lo que pasó.
3. **B)** La fecha.
4. **B)** Saludo.
5. **C)** Because = porque.
6. **A)** Proud.
7. **C)** Mayúsculas y went.
8. **B)** Por último.
9. **A)** Falso amigo.
10. **A)** Revisar.

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Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. Friday, 6th May.
2. First, Then, After that, Finally.
3. because.
4. so.
5. proud, relieved, disappointed.
6. I woke up and I had breakfast.
7. Model answer: I was so excited because I always wanted a puppy!
8. Yesterday my friend and I went to the park.
9. Model answer: I can't wait for tomorrow! / I hope tomorrow is better.
10. Model answer: Tuesday, 15th March. Dear Diary, today was busy. First, I had a maths test. Then I played basketball and we won. I felt really proud because I scored six points.

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